POWERPLAY — Mechanics Reference Card

The corporate compliance handbook your characters never bothered to read. Quick lookup of every named mechanic.

Power is checked, not spent unless explicitly paid (e.g., PowerPlay!) — the Board appreciates ambition without asking it to liquidate. Full definitions are in the Manual § II.

Power Floors (Assets Only) — the club has one door

Power Floors apply to **Assets only**. **Action and Reaction cards are free to play, with no Power Floor.** Lobbyists meet a lower bar than CEOs; CEOs meet a lower bar than oligarchs.

Tier	Asset Buy Floor	Asset Use Floor
T1	0 P	0 P
T2	2 P	2 P
T3	3 P	3 P

Applies to draw / Draft pull / Private Equity of Assets of that tier (a Draft pull of T2/T3 also needs ½ printed cost in Coins). The same floor governs which Assets may fire via synergy activation (see Activation Ladder and Ability Lock).

Track your Power on the **Power Track** dial (0–9, then 10 → 100). The labelled rungs are your unlock ladder: **1 = PowerPlay!**, **2 = Tier 2 + Character Ability**, **3 = Tier 3**.

Ability Lock — the perks-and-Power club

When a player's Power drops below an Asset's Use Floor, that Asset's Synergy is **locked** — it cannot fire even when a matching card is played. The executive suite needs a sufficiently impressive resume. **Income still flows. Op Costs still apply** — the rank-and-file keeps the lights on regardless. The Synergy unlocks automatically when Power meets / exceeds the Use Floor again.

Countering (Reactions)

Action and Reaction decks are **tier-less single piles** — there are no tier restrictions on Countering:

- **Any Reaction can Counter any Action** — or any **individual Asset Synergy fire** (each fire is a separate event with its own response window, so a 3-fire Action offers up to 3 separate Counter opportunities).
- **Reactions mitigate, not negate** — playing a Reaction reduces or compensates for the incoming effect; it does not fully cancel the Action or fire. Direct prevention is capped at 2 Coins of value; larger losses resolve and the Reaction's compensation applies instead.
- **No Reaction-to-Reaction** — a Reaction can never be played in response to another Reaction. The chain always ends at the first Reaction.
- **Response-only** — a Reaction is never played proactively on your own turn; it always answers a trigger (an Action card, a synergy fire, or an Event).
- **Sacred plays open no response window at all** (see Sacred).

Activation Ladder (Industry Synergy)

Playing a card fires **your own Assets'** Synergy clauses by matching Industry. Cards carry Industry tags (Actions: primary + secondary; Reactions: one); only the playing player's portfolio counts.

- **Action — Base (free with card play)**: the card's base effect resolves AND **2 of your primary-Industry Assets fire** their Synergy clauses.
- **Action — Influencing Decision (pay 1 Influence, optional)**: the card's **secondary Industry is unlocked** and **1 more Asset fires** (from either Industry) — **3 fires total**. No Coin activation costs; no other levels. You may declare it only if you hold 1 Influence when

you play the card.
- **Reaction**: on play, **1 matching-Industry Asset fires automatically** (no cost, no ladder).

Each Asset fires at most once per card play, gated by its Use Floor. The Asset's owner picks the target of each fire (self-target allowed unless the clause names "an opponent"). **Resolution**: fires resolve one at a time, in the order the acting player chooses; each targeted player gets a chance to React before their fire resolves. If several players want to React to the same fire, the player earliest in turn order from the Leader goes first — and the targeted player always has first right before a bystander defends them.

- **Action** fires: checked against the **Attacker's** Assets.
- **Reaction** fires: checked against the **Reactor's** Assets (may not be the Defender).

Sacred — above the audit

Some plays are simply too well-connected to question. For a **Sacred** action, ability, or effect, **the response window does not open at all** — no Reaction may be played against it (no Counter, no mitigation, no compensation), and no Asset or character ability can intercept it; it resolves with zero opponent interaction. Sacred applies to **PowerPlay! itself** and to **Asset Synergy fires declared Sacred via PowerPlay!** (up to 2 per PowerPlay! turn). No character ability grants Sacred.

PowerPlay! — Sacred Free Action

Pay **1 P** → this turn you may **play up to 2 Action cards**; **one of them gets the Influencing Decision for free** (the other can still buy it for 1 Influence); draw **1 Action card + 1 Reaction card**; and you may **declare up to 2 Asset Synergy fires Sacred** (declare when the fire triggers, before any Reaction is committed against it). Once per turn. Sacred.

Attach

A card persists on a target Asset (or player) until a condition is met or its duration expires. **Infrastructure-primary Action cards attach to Assets**; **max 1 attachment per Asset** — a friendly attachment blocks a hostile one by occupying the slot, and vice versa. Duration follows what the card affects:

Attachment	Clears at
Hostile, affects the Asset's Synergy (silence, freeze)	the Asset owner's **next Organize the Desk**
Friendly, affects the Asset's Synergy (shield)	the Asset owner's **next turn's** Organize the Desk (so it survives the Lunch Break and the opponents' turns)
Affects income (boost or debuff)	the **next income roll**, then discard immediately

During Organize the Desk, remove expired Attached cards from your Assets and yourself. A **Freeze is an Attached "freeze" card** — removing it at Organize the Desk is how a Frozen Asset unfreezes (a Frozen Asset still earns income). Financial tokens (Loans, IOUs) follow their own rules and are NOT cleared at Organize the Desk.

Loan (Corporate Debt) — patience with interest

Relationship: player ↔ supply (bank). No Attacker, no Defender — the bank is your counterparty. Distinct from an IOU (see below), which is player ↔ player.

- **Take a Loan** (at the Lunch Break, or during Bankruptcy Resolution — never a turn action): up to **floor(printed cost / 2)** from the supply, secured against an Asset (collateral → Asset Mortgaged).
- **Max 2 active loans / player** (checked at the Lunch Break; if 3+, default one).
- **Maintenance**: 1 C / active loan at Call-it-a-Night. **Grace round** on the round of acquisition.
- **Voluntary repayment** (at Call-it-a-Night): pay **principal + 1 C** → Asset unmortgaged.

- **Mortgaged Assets cannot be sold** (by any means) while the loan is active — repay the loan to unmortgage the Asset before selling it. (They do still earn income.)
- **Default**: attached Asset → discard; bank pays printed cost to **the player**; the player pays principal + 1 C; the player keeps the surplus (1 C / 3 C / 6 C for T1/T2/T3). Loan discharged. **No elimination from loan default.**

IOU (Player Debt) — a polite gun at your head

Relationship: player ↔ player — the Defender owes the Attacker. Distinct from a Loan (above), which is player ↔ supply. The IOU lives in the Attacker's possession until settled or traded.

When an Action effect demands a resource the Defender lacks → the Defender takes a **Coin-denominated IOU** held by the Attacker instead. The Board accepts promissory notes. The Board also remembers them.

Shortfall	IOU value (per missing unit)
1 IP	4 C (3 + 1 interest)
1 P	7 C (6 + 1 interest)
1 C	(X + 1) C

- **Cap**: 2 new IOUs / Defender / round (further triggers floor at 0).
- **Settlement**: at Call-it-a-Night Debt Settlement (after voluntary loan repayment, before Thievery).
- **Order**: voluntary IOU repayment → negotiation → forced liquidation (Defender picks an unencumbered Asset; bank pays printed cost; Defender pays Attacker MIN(IOU, available C); cascades).
- **Elimination only if** an IOU is unpaid AND no unencumbered Assets remain AND no negotiated agreement is reached.
- **Tradable** in the Lunch Break Trading Window (a creditor may sell an IOU to a third party). **Attacker elimination wipes their held IOUs.**

Signing Bonus

One-time grant when you acquire an Asset from the **Market Operation draft or Private Equity**. **Does NOT apply on trades or forced/hostile transfers** (e.g., Hostile Takeover).

Tier	Signing Bonus
T1	none
T2	Gain 1 IP
T3	Gain 1 Power

Character Action — Free, Once per Round

Free Action with **no cost at all** — activating your Character Ability spends no Coins, Influence, or Power. Requirements: you must **hold at least 2 Power** (checked, not spent), and each ability may only be used **during the specific phase printed on the character card**. **Frequency: once per round** (1 use across both of your turns). No character starts with any Power (everyone starts at 0), and no character ability grants Sacred.

Resource Flow Notation

Card text follows a consistent vocabulary:

Phrase	Meaning

`gain X`	Receive from supply (no transfer between players).
`lose X`	Lose to supply (no transfer).
`pay X to [player]`	Direct transfer from one player to another.
`take X from [player]` / `steal X from [player]`	Transfer from named player to playing player.

Defaults: "Attacker gains +Y" without a source → supply. "Defender loses Y" without a destination → supply.

Counter-Verbs (single-line)

Verb	Meaning
Counter	Respond to an Action or an individual synergy fire with a Reaction; **mitigates** (reduces or compensates), does not fully negate. Any Reaction can Counter any Action.
Prevent	Block a specific effect (loss or damage).
Redirect	Send the effect to another player.
Replace	Discard 1 card of the specified type → draw 1 new card of the same type.